

# Aviv Gelfand

📍 Jerusalem, Israel

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## Summary

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- Early-career Data Scientist with production-level experience in DS roles across tech, academia, military, and training industries. MSc in progress (HUJI, Data Science); BSc Statistics & Data Science (HUJI, GPA: 89).
- Proven ability to research, design, and implement secure and robust ML solutions, in complex real-world settings, combining high-level software engineering practices with close collaboration and rapid self-learning.
- Dedicated to long-term growth in a full-time role at a DS/ML/AI team, and help turn innovative ideas into reality.

## Experience

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### Data Scientist

2024 – present

*Darrow AI - Data Science Team*

- Designed and deployed an A-Z production pipeline that uncovered a \$1M+ value sale. Leveraged few-shot Chain-of-Thought LLM prompting, optimised costs with OpenAI's Batch API, enriched and filtered lead databases with domain-specific intelligence, integrating multi-source web scraping.
- Performed numerous model evaluations and error analyses, collaborating with senior DSs, DEs, PMs, and other stakeholders, with safety constraints and vulnerability assessments.
- Worked with AWS environment, Airflow, Atlassian (JIRA). Built pipelines querying across model endpoints, S3 data lakes, Elastic / OpenSearch, and PostgreSQL databases.

### NLP Data Scientist & Research Assistant

2023 – 2024

*Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Adi Leibovitch's Quantitative Legal Research lab*

- Executed Supervised-Fine-Tuning of open-source LLMs to classify textual argument-types in trials; reduced labeling time and errors, replacing manual tagging with LLM-based tagging. Applied PEFT and LoRA with HF, PyTorch, and CUDA.
- Achieved over 90% accuracy and 80% F1 scores in most target labels. Saved days of model complexity and training time using efficient sampling, overcoming significant imbalance.
- Presented findings and achievements at a prominent statistics and data science conference in May 2024.

### Statistics & Machine Learning Instructor

2022 – 2024

*Upscale Analytics*

- Built dozens of hands-on ML projects as assignments for a practical course in statistical inference and classic ML, with constant feedback from a Senior Data Scientist (and head lecturer), Michael Winer.
- Advanced from teaching assistant to instructor, then to a full rights partner after 3 successful semesters of weekly TA sessions with a significant presence of students. Worked primarily with Scikit-Learn, SciPy, and XGBoost Libraries.

### Programmer & Research Assistant

2022 – 2023

*Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Renana Peres's Computational Social Science Lab*

- Self-taught and programmed smart contracts with a C++-based programming language. Developed a simulation interface (React.js). Designed and analyzed experiments, web-scraped data monthly, and did literature and academic peer reviews.

### Data Analyst & Research Team Leader

2015 – 2020

*Israel Defense Forces (Volunteered, Lieutenant)*

- Conducted research, threat assessments, and analysis for high-ranked decision-makers and multiplied my team's work products.
- Led cross-org initiatives, yielding in-depth research papers via unprecedented cooperations with research branches.

## Education

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### The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

2024 – 2026

*MSc in Data Science — LLMs-focused Thesis, guided by Prof. Ariel Jaffe.*

### The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

2021 – 2024

*BSc in Statistics & Data Science (GPA 89)*

## Skills and Technologies

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**Scripting Languages and Tools:** Python, Java, Solidity (C++ based), R, SQL, JS;

**GenAI Tools:** Prompt engineering techniques (CoT, Few-Shot, etc), output schemas, fine-tuning open-source LLMs

**EDA & ETL:** Visualizing, cleaning, encoding/embedding; Pandas, NumPy; DataBricks, AWS OpenSearch, and RDS (PostgreSQL)

**ML & Stats:** SKLearn, PyTorch, PEFT, LORA; model evaluations, error analysis, robust measurements, efficient sampling

**CI/CD & Other:** AWS (ECS, SSM, Parameter Store, S3), Aiflow, DataDog, sh scripts, GitHub workflows